Medicine and the body

1. Read the article once for meaning. 2. Read it again and look at the **highlighted new words** and the **blue phrases** in context. 3. Study the tables. 4. Use at least 5 new words in speaking or writing this week.

Article: Modern medicine: from diagnosis to recovery (180 words)

Medicine has made enormous progress. An early **diagnosis** can mean the difference between an easy **therapy** and serious **surgery**, and a carefully planned **clinical trial** tests any new drug on volunteers before it reaches the public. Doctors give a precise **dose**, and a pharmacist will only supply the medicine against a **prescription**. An **antibiotic** can cure a bacterial **infection**, but it is useless against a virus, and overuse helps **bacteria** to resist treatment.

The body defends itself through **immunity**, and a **vaccine** trains this system to fight a disease before it attacks. Understanding how a **cell** works, and how healthy **tissue** repairs itself, helps scientists to treat each **organ** separately. A sudden **outbreak** can turn into a **pandemic** when a disease spreads quickly across borders, as recent years have shown.

Long-term care also matters. A patient with a chronic **disorder** may need years of **rehabilitation** and a long period of **recovery**. **Life-saving** drugs are often expensive, which raises difficult questions of fairness. Medical teams **work around the clock** to **come up with** new treatments, but they cannot **make up for** healthy habits.

Useful phrases from the article

PHRASE	MEANING
work around the clock	work day and night
come up with	invent
make up for	replace

The 20 new words

WORD		MEANING	EXAMPLE
diagnosis	n	identifying an illness	*An early diagnosis saves lives.*
therapy	n	treatment of a disease	*Physical therapy helped his recovery.*
surgery	n	medical treatment by cutting the body	*She needed heart surgery.*
antibiotic	n	a medicine that kills bacteria	*Antibiotics do not cure viruses.*
infection	n	a disease caused by germs	*The infection spread quickly.*
pandemic	n	a disease that spreads across the world	*The pandemic changed daily life.*
clinical trial	n	a test of a new medicine on people	*The clinical trial involved 500 patients.*

dose	n	the amount of medicine taken at one time	*Take one dose every morning.*
prescription	n	a doctor's written order for medicine	*You need a prescription for this drug.*
recovery	n	getting well again	*His recovery took three months.*
vaccine	n	a substance that protects from disease	*The vaccine is very effective.*
immunity	n	protection against disease	*Immunity develops after infection.*
organ	n	a part of the body with a job	*The liver is a vital organ.*
bacteria	n	tiny living things that can cause illness	*Bacteria live in the human gut.*
cell	n	the smallest unit of a living thing	*Cancer begins when cells grow abnormally.*
tissue	n	material from which parts of the body are made	*Muscle tissue repairs itself.*
disorder	n	an illness affecting the body or mind	*Sleep disorders are common.*
rehabilitation	n	treatment to recover strength	*Rehabilitation lasted six weeks.*
outbreak	n	a sudden start of a disease	*An outbreak of measles closed the school.*
life-saving	adj	able to save lives	*Life-saving drugs are expensive.*

Revision: 10 words from last week

WORD		MEANING
erosion	n	the wearing away of land by water or wind
glacier	n	a huge mass of slowly moving ice
earthquake	n	a sudden shaking of the ground
volcano	n	a mountain that sends out hot rock
tide	n	the regular rise and fall of the sea
altitude	n	height above sea level
terrain	n	the type of land
arid	adj	very dry
humid	adj	containing a lot of moisture
flood	n	water covering normally dry land

Practice: fill the gaps

rehabilitation · diagnosis · infection · tissue · antibiotic · pandemic · recovery · disorder

1. _____ lasted six weeks.
2. An early _____ saves lives.

3. The _____ spread quickly.
4. Muscle _____ repairs itself.
5. _____ do not cure viruses.
6. The _____ changed daily life.
7. His _____ took three months.
8. Sleep _____ are common.

More words on this topic (not in the article: choose the 10 most useful for you)

acute (adj): severe but short
ailment (n): a minor illness
allergy (n): a reaction to a substance
ambulance (n): a vehicle for taking people to hospital
anesthetic (n): a drug that stops pain
artery (n): a blood vessel from the heart
blood pressure (n): the force of blood in the vessels
cancer (n): a disease of uncontrolled cells
carrier (n): a person who can pass on a disease
checkup (n): a routine examination
contagious (adj): spreading by contact
cure (n): a treatment that ends a disease
donor (n): a person who gives blood or an organ
fatal (adj): causing death
fever (n): high body temperature
fracture (n): a broken bone
gene therapy (n): treating disease by changing genes
heartbeat (n): the beat of the heart
hormone (n): a chemical that controls body functions
injection (n): medicine put in with a needle
lung (n): an organ used for breathing
nursing (n): looking after the sick
paramedic (n): an emergency medical worker
pill (n): a small tablet of medicine
specialist (n): a doctor with expert knowledge
stroke (n): a sudden loss of blood to the brain
transplant (n): replacing an organ
virus (n): a tiny germ that causes disease
ward (n): a room in a hospital

Answers

1. Rehabilitation (rehabilitation)
2. diagnosis (diagnosis)
3. infection (infection)
4. tissue (tissue)
5. Antibiotics (antibiotic)
6. pandemic (pandemic)
7. recovery (recovery)
8. disorders (disorder)